CONFERENCE ABSTRACT

Ayurveda for Public Health

Swasthavritta, Dinacharya, Ritucharya, Rasayana and community medicine

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Venue
Ayurveda & Public Health symposium

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> *Ayurveda was a public-health system long before the phrase existed. This abstract makes the case for its revival.*

Abstract

Ayurveda is an ancient medical science of human civilisation and a holistic health science that addresses the individual as well as the community. Owing to severe pollution, climate change, population growth and other socio-economic pressures, the world today faces a strong survival strain on all living beings and on nature; maintaining the wholeness of nature and human health is a pressing obligation that cannot be ignored. Ayurveda has distinctive advantages here, because it directly fulfils social health demands. Swasthavritta — the promotion of health — is among the strongest and most unique aspects of Ayurvedic medicine. Ayurveda places emphasis on rules of conduct and their effect on the social and behavioural aspects of life, addressing both preventive and curative dimensions of health and promoting wellbeing through organised community effort. Classical Ayurvedic texts already describe infectious disease, immunity and nutrition within their own idioms. With Dinacharya, Ritucharya, Rasayana and Vajikarana, individual health can be improved; and with Yoga, meditation and immune-modulating Ahara, the wider public-health aim can be met.

Public health · Swasthavritta · Ahara · Dinacharya · Ritucharya · Rasayana · Community medicine · Ayurveda · Prevention

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Full text

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Ayurveda for Public health

Ayurveda is an ancient medical science of the human civilization. It is holistic health science which deals individual as well as at community level in entirely. As we all know due to severe pollution, climate change, population rise & other socio-economic reasons our world is suffering a strong survival strain of all living being and nature. Maintaining the wholeness of nature and human health is a big objection in front of the world and it can not be ignored either. Ayurveda system has its own advantages that it is also fulfill the social health demands. Swasthavritta or the promotion of health is one of the strongest & most unique aspects of ayurvedic medicine. Ayurveda emphasizes on the rules of conduct & its effect on social & behavioral aspects of life. It deals with preventive, curative aspects and promoting health and efficiency through organized community efforts. Classical texts of ayurveda describe many principles such as infectious disease, immunity, nutritions etc.

Public health today is gaining momentum all over and is a good sign for traditionally medical systems to get their place to fulfill the need of the day. But the ancient texts of ayurveda also describe certain principles of public health in its idioms. With the help of Dinacharya, Ritucharya, Rasayana and Vajikarana one can improve their health. Yoga is an atomistic science which embraces physical, moral, social, mental and spiritual well-being.

Ayurveda has the outstanding potential to reverse the worsening health status across the world and it would be the best option to promote public health through yoga, meditation along with immune modulators as ahara.

Key words:-

Public health, Ahara, Dinacharya, Ritucharya, Rasayana

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